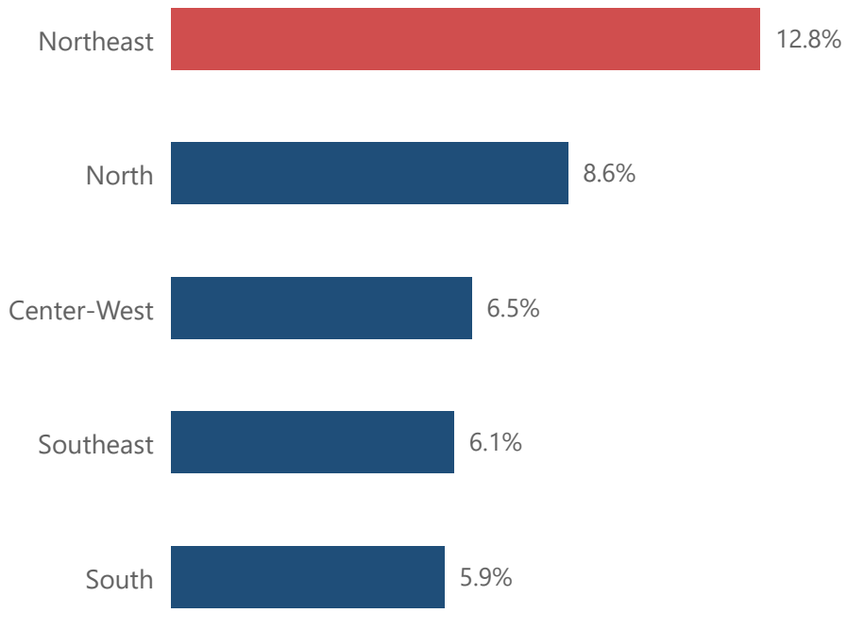
Olist grew through more orders, not bigger baskets, and growth stalled in 2018

GMV	Delivered orders	AOV	Return rate (2+ days)	Late rate	Freight share
R$ 13.18M	96,211	R$ 137.00	2.2%	6.8%	14.3%

GMV rose five-fold in 2017, then plateaued at about R$ 0.9M a month



The Northeast's late rate is twice the Southeast's



Delivered orders, Jan 2017 – Aug 2018. Region = customer's latest address. Return rate = customers who bought on 2+ different days.

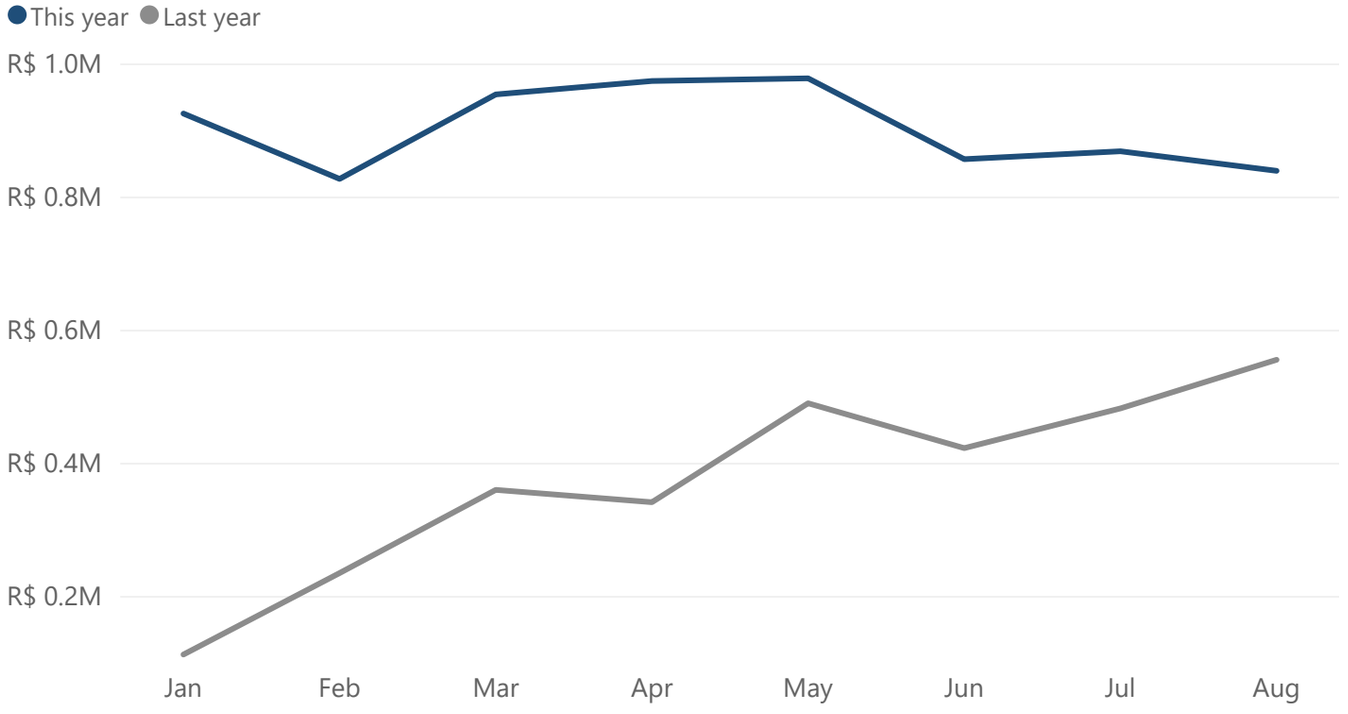
Growth came from more orders, not bigger baskets, and it is slowing

Year

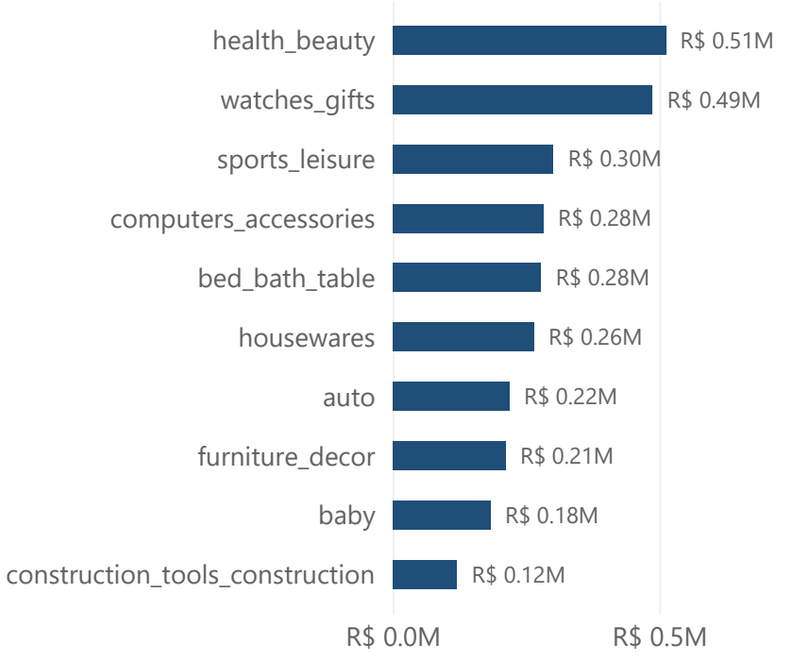
2017 | 2018

GMV	GMV vs last year	Orders vs last year	AOV vs last year	Items per Order
R$ 7.22M	+141.1%	+139.9%	+0.5%	1.14

Every month of 2018 beat 2017, but the gap narrowed from +727% to +51%



Growth was broad-based: the top 5 categories delivered only 44%

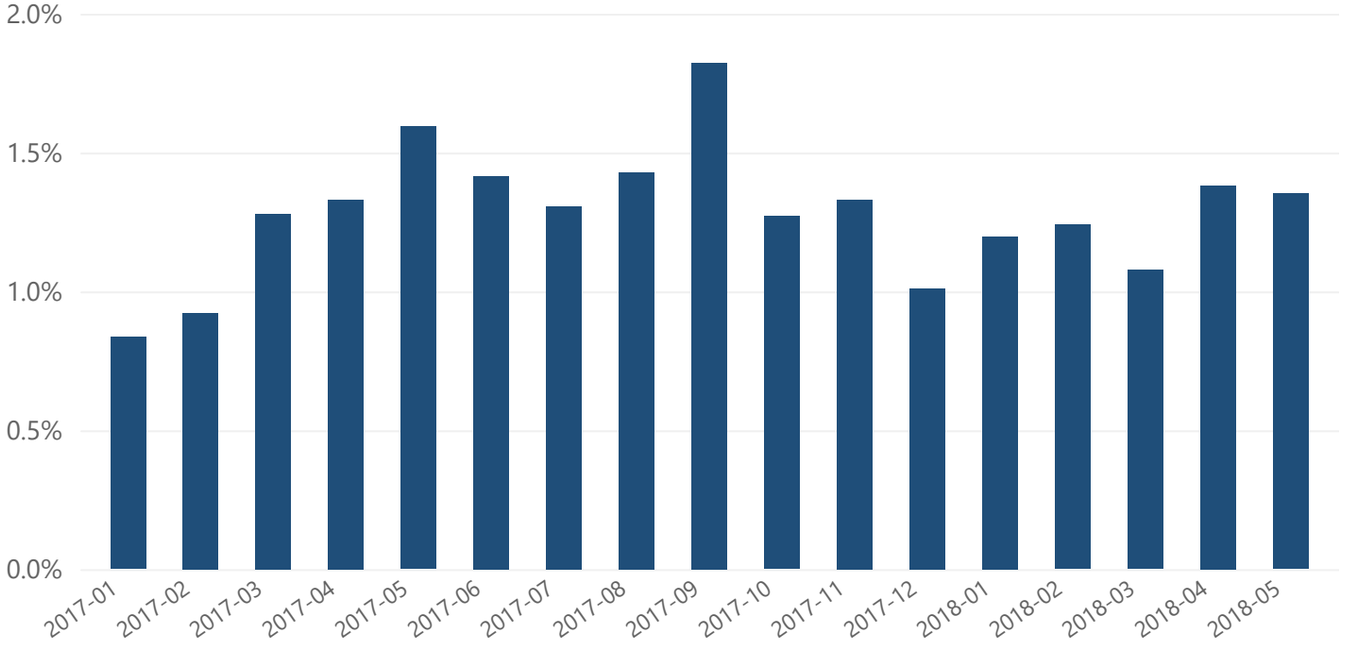


Delivered orders. Each year covers Jan–Aug only (analysis period ends Aug 2018), so 2018 vs 2017 is like-for-like. GMV excludes freight.

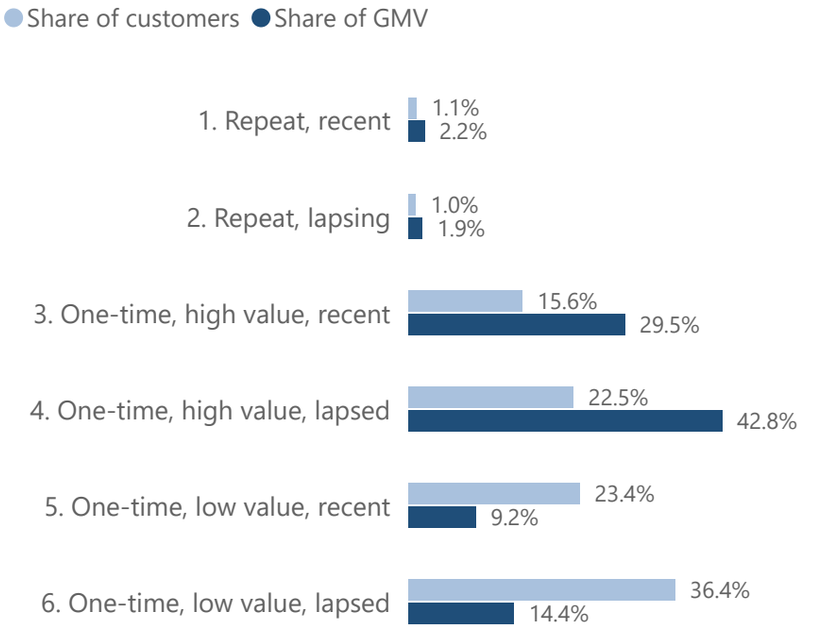
Olist is almost entirely a one-purchase marketplace: about 2 in 100 customers return within six months

Customers	Returning customers	Return rate (any time)	Return in 90 days	Return in 180 days	Returners' GMV share
93,104	2,005	2.15%	1.30%	1.98%	4.13%

Return rates did not improve as Olist scaled: about 1.5% in mid-2017 cohorts, 1.25% in 2018



One-time buyers in the top 40% by spend generate 72% of GMV; repeat buyers only 4%

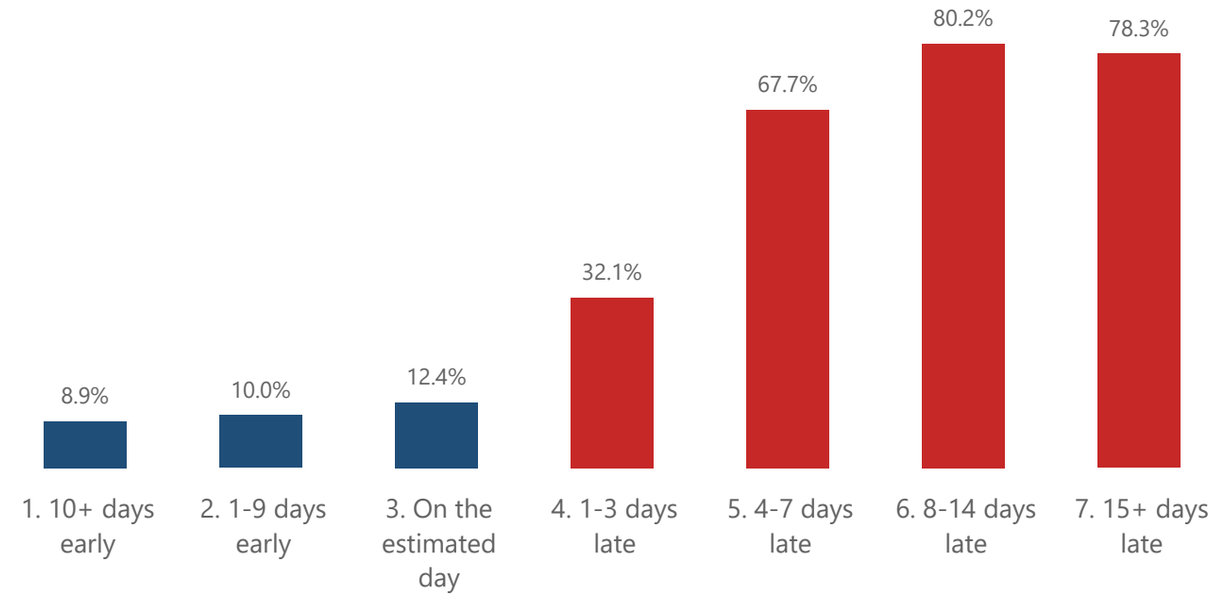


Customers with a delivered order, Jan 2017 – Aug 2018. Return = purchase on a later day. 90/180-day rates use only cohorts whose full window ends by Aug 2018 (no bar = not yet observable). RFM: recency at 2018-09-01; frequency 1 vs 2+ purchase days.

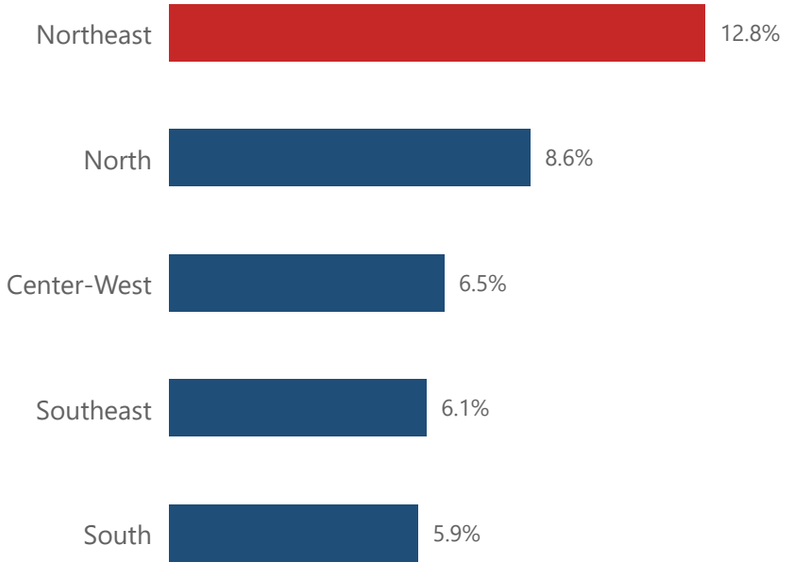
Late delivery drives bad reviews: 7% of orders arrive late, and the damage starts on day one

Late rate	Score, on time	Score, late	Late share of 1–2★	Extra carrier days	Extra seller days
6.8%	4.29	2.27	32.6%	+19.9	+3.0

Bad reviews jump from 12% to 32% at just 1–3 days late, and reach 80% after a week



The Northeast's late rate is twice the Southeast's, but the Southeast holds 62% of late orders

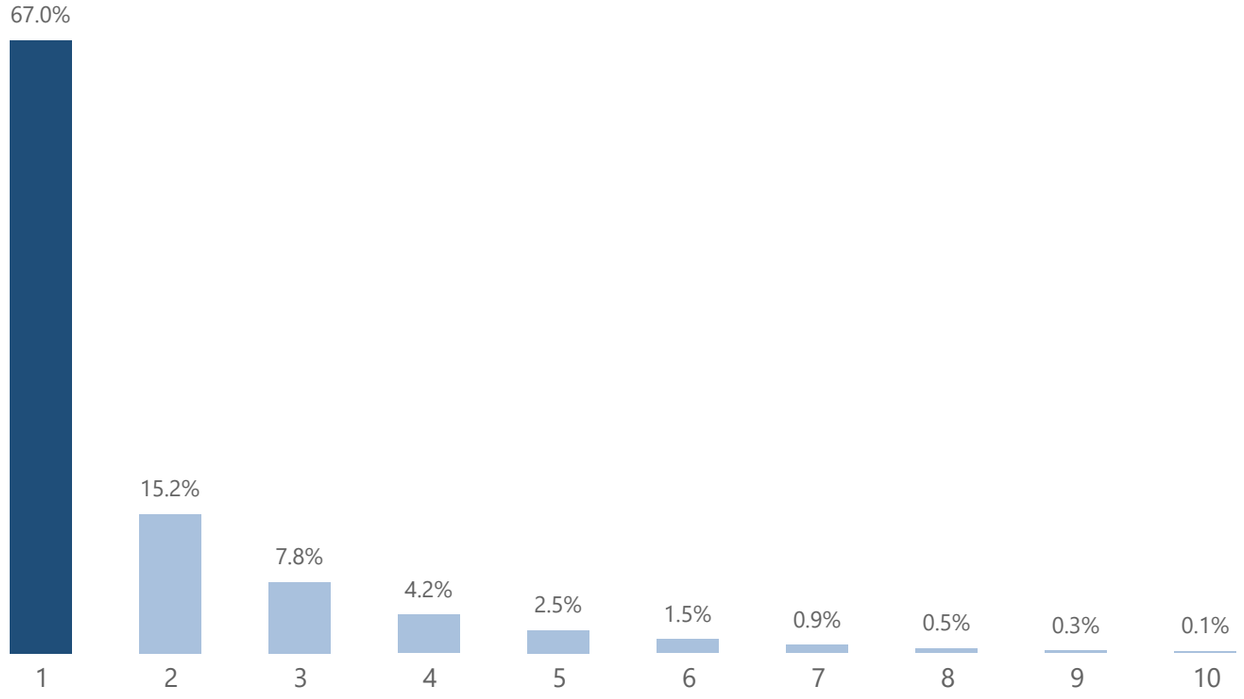


Delivered orders, Jan 2017 – Aug 2018. Late = delivered after the estimated date. Region = delivery address at the time of the order. Transit and handover averages exclude flagged records (T3, T4, T5). Low scores = 1–2 stars among reviewed orders

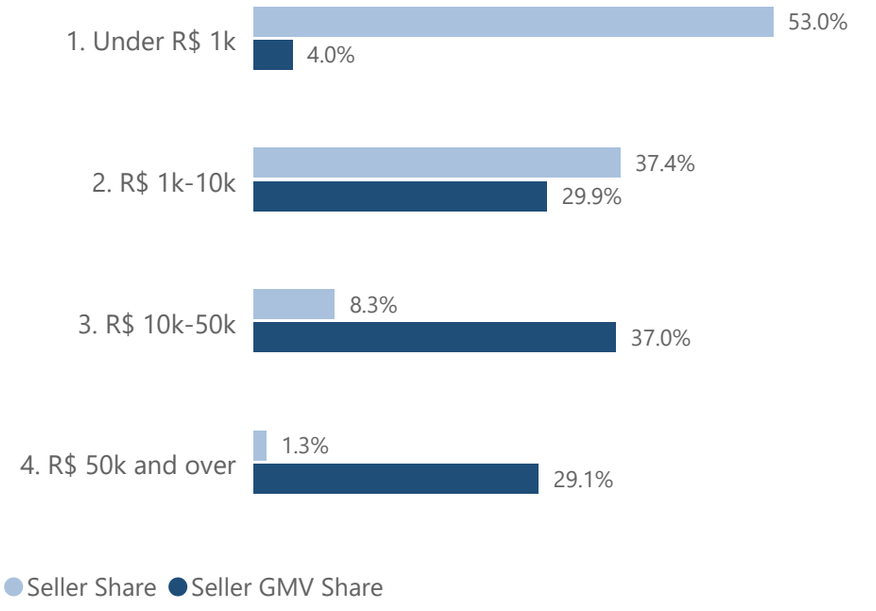
Olist runs on a core of about 300 sellers: the top 10% generate two-thirds of GMV, but no single seller is critical

Active sellers	Top 10% sellers	Top 10 sellers	Equivalent sellers	Sellers under 1k	Sold only once
2,945	67.0%	13.3%	275	53.0%	17.5%

The top 10% of sellers generate 67% of GMV; the bottom half generate 3%



Mid-sized sellers are the backbone: 8% of sellers, 37% of GMV

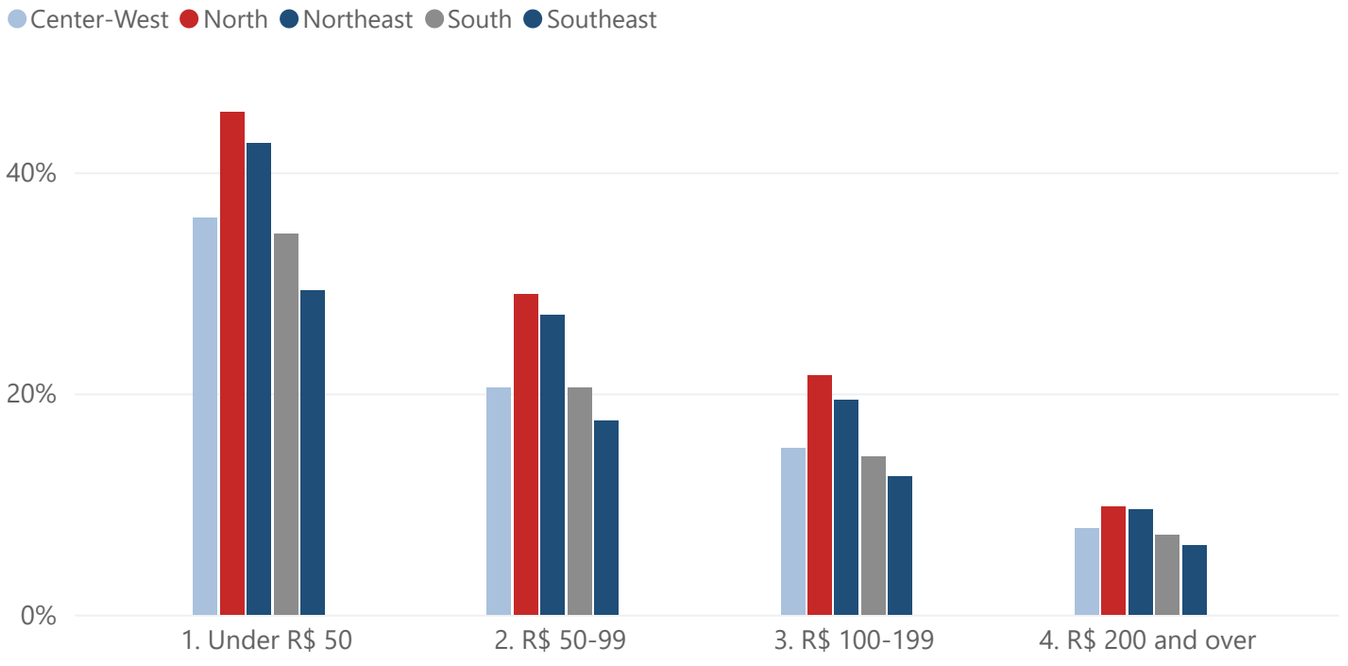


Sellers with delivered GMV, Jan 2017 – Aug 2018. Decile 1 = top 10% of sellers by GMV. Equivalent sellers = 10,000 ÷ HHI (GMV as if split equally among that many sellers). Service rates in the decile tooltips are item-weighted.

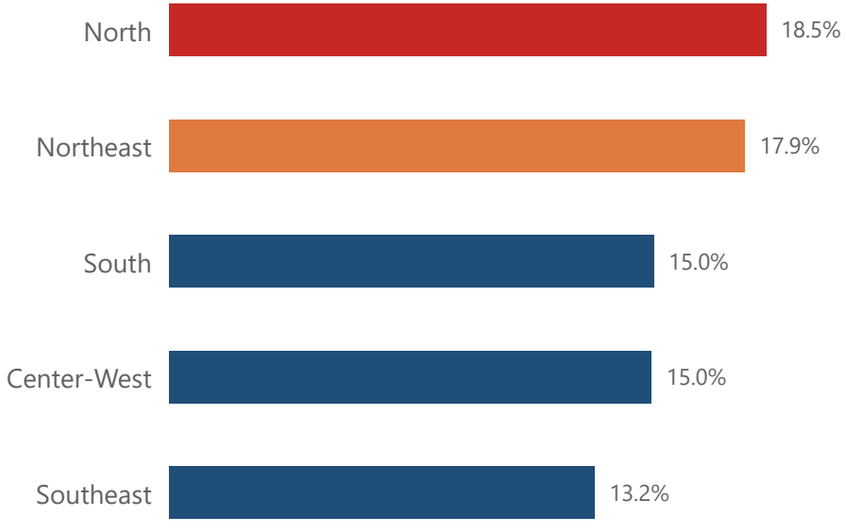
Freight takes 14% of what customers pay; cheap items and remote regions carry the heaviest burden

Freight share	Freight per item	Typical order	Orders over 25%	Items under R$ 50	Items R$ 200+
14.3%	R$ 19.95	18.3%	30.3%	32.0%	7.1%

Price matters more than distance: freight is 32% of cheap items' cost vs 7% for R$ 200+, and the North pays most in every band



North and Northeast pay 18–19% in freight vs 13% in the Southeast, below the 25% hypothesised



Delivered orders, Jan 2017 – Aug 2018. Freight share = freight ÷ (item price + freight), calculated as a ratio of sums, never an average of ratios. Region = delivery address at the time of the order. Typical order = median order-level freight share.

Freight per Item

R$ 19.95

Freight Share R$200+

7.1%

Median Order Freight Share

18.3%

Freight Share Under R$50

32.0%

Orders Over 25% Freight

30.3%